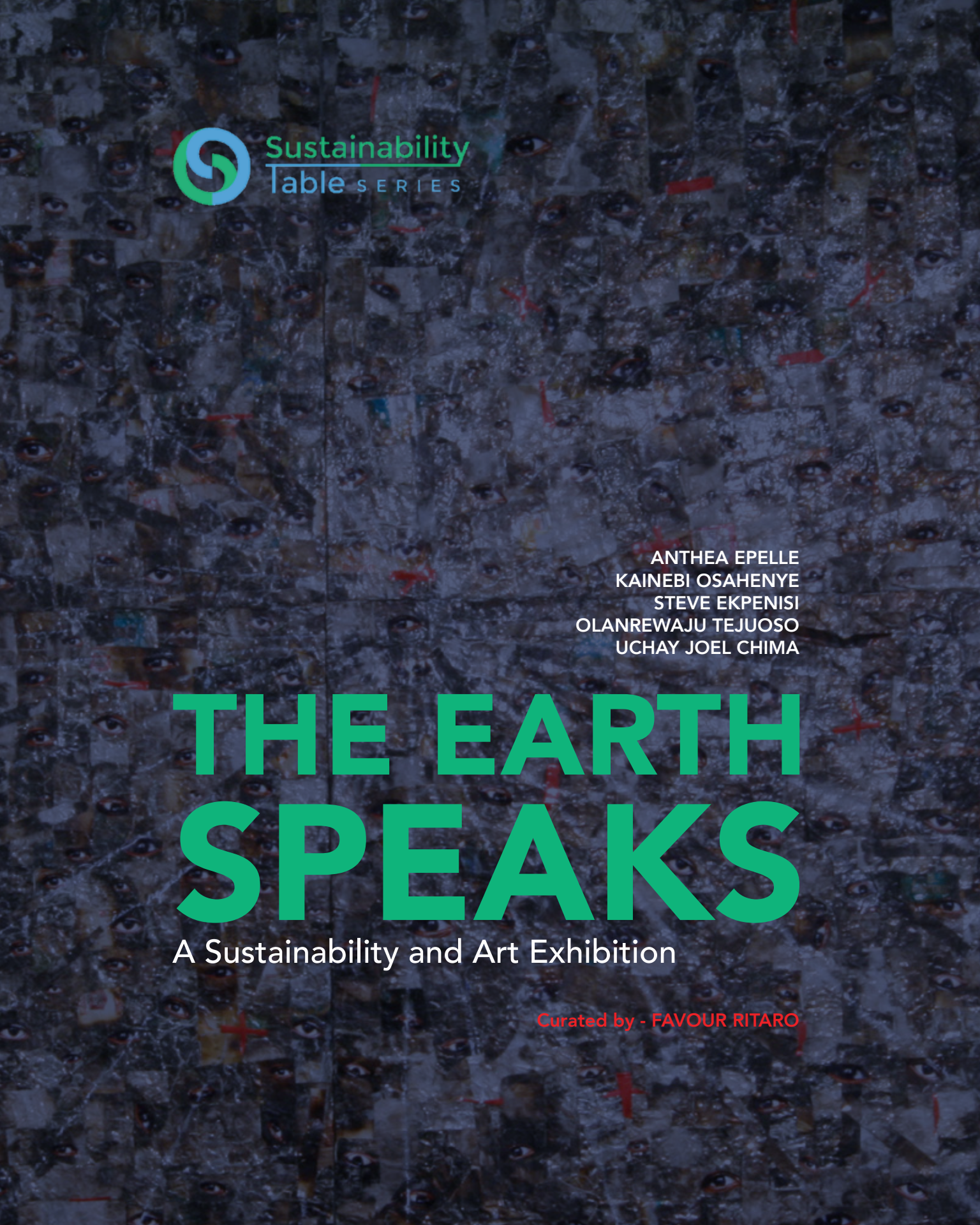

Sustainability
Table SERIES
ANTHEA EPELLE
KAINEBI OSAHENYE
STEVE EKPENISI
OLANREWAJU TEJUOSO
UCHAY JOEL CHIMA
THE EARTH SPEAKS
A Sustainability and Art Exhibition
Curated by - FAVOUR RITARO

Sustainability Table SERIES

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THE EARTH SPEAKS

A Sustainability and Art Exhibition

Curated by - FAVOUR RITARO

18th, November 2021 **07.00 PM**
Lagos Oriental Hotel, Victoria Island, Lagos.

standard chartered
IHS Towers of strength
AVANT GARDE
KEBBI STATE
StretfordHill
IMSE
LSETF

Preface

As efforts are being made globally towards achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), we must begin to find innovative ways to communicate issues of sustainability, especially as it pertains to the environment.

While there are several campaigns about climate change, global warming and rising sea levels, we must ensure that we are telling the stories in relatable and creative forms.

The Earth Speaks is an Art Exhibition that is targeted to serve as a visual and artistic expression of the 2021 Sustainability Discourse Series (STS).

The Sustainability Table Discourse Series (STS) is a platform that brings together policy makers, entrepreneurs, sustainable development experts, leading corporate organisations and various subject matter experts to share ideas/initiatives and proffer solutions to challenges facing selected industries as it relates to the environment, climate change, sustainability. The platform, which is now in its fifth-year, focuses on achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), a digital, circular and green economy, likewise working on multilateral, regional or continental African and global issues.

Among the objectives of this year's edition is to stir conversations and have genuine arguments in the direction of sustainability to achieve the SDGs.

The art exhibition explores the relationship between earth and her inhabitants as well as the many ways the earth communicates with us. We have identified that art is as much a powerful storytelling tool as it provides a creative channel to effective waste management. Hence, the exhibition brings together prolific artists who are passionate about sustainability and employ waste materials to create beautiful works of art.

We hope that each artwork, just like the earth, would speak to the mind of the viewers, inspiring a sense of sustainability and spurring ideas and initiatives that proffer solutions to issues of sustainable development in our nation towards a sustainable future.

— **Kayode Olaniyan**
Convener, Sustainability Table Discourse



Curatorial Statement

The Earth Speaks is a group exhibition exploring the constant relationship between humans and the earth. Through the works of artists living and working in Nigeria, the exhibition will examine the intricacies of human interactions and activities the resulting consequences on our changing environment, and the influence on our shared humanity. The Earth Speaks aims to transcend polarities and evokes a deeper relationship between humans and nature in this age of angst, global warming, societal discrimination, gender inequality, and prevailing economic challenges.

We have all experienced unprecedented upheaval in planetary history. With the happenings of climate change, other ecological crises, human rights violations, terrorism, economic recession, and the Covid-19 pandemic which has recently plagued our world, there is no better time to rethink the future of our humanity and environment than now. In this time of global distress, the exhibition argues that environmental protection, human rights, equitable human development, and peace are intertwined. It, therefore, presents work that re-evaluates current political structures and societal norms.

Contrary to mainstream portrayals of planetary catastrophism, this exhibition will weave together artistic, environmental, social, and political conversations, and emphasize the core importance of a harmonious relationship between mankind and its environment for a sustainable future. Through various subject matters, the exhibition aims to compel viewers to reconsider the relationships between humans, and her environment. The Earth Speaks is an invitation into a future where the planet and its inhabitants thrive and coexist harmoniously.

We have been inundated with so much about climate change recently and scientific evidence shows that global temperatures are rising at an unprecedented level that is not sustainable and is detrimental to the earth's survival. Similarly, tons of municipal solid wastes which are not properly managed or recycled have made their way into the sea, threatening sea life and impacting our lands. The exhibition, therefore, brings into cognizance all these issues, identifying, and bringing together artists who employ the use of found materials in their artistic practice; telling stories that advocate for sustainable day-to-day practices and development.

Finally, the exhibition will shed light on various ways the earth has been urging and nudging its habitats prior to now. Art has always played a critical role in provoking thought and generating dialogues. We intend to generate awareness on these issues by using the universal language of art as a catalyst for people to focus on human and environmental values.

The Earth Speaks is a timely exhibition as efforts are being made globally to align with, and attain the 17 UN Sustainable Development Goals by 2030. As part of the Avant Garde 2021 Sustainability Table Discussion Series, the exhibition seeks to interact with and engage the audience, evoking conversations via a visual approach.

— **Favour Ritaro**

Exhibiting Artists

Kainebi Osahenye



Steve Ekpenisi





Anthea Epelle



Olanrewaju Tejuoso



Uchay Joel Chima

Kainebi Osahenye



Born in Agbor, Delta state, Nigeria, Kainebi Osahenye has worked consistently over the past decades to tackles issues of mortality, spirituality, consumerism, identity and the environment. Working as a sculptor, painter and multimedia artist, Kainebi is known for his trademark of layering, stacking and sequencing objects, sometimes in their thousands, creating repetitive, and multi-media works. He has used burnt, and crushed beverage cans, water bottles, newspapers, chicken wire, fabric, juice packs and many other found objects to create intricate and sometimes monumental art works.

Osahenye studied at the Auchi Polytechnic, as well as, the Yaba College of Technology, graduating with a major in painting in 1989. In 2012, Osahenye received a Masters of Fine Arts (MFA) from Goldsmith College in the UK. Osahenye is one of Nigeria's foremost contemporary artists.

Kainebi has taken part in numerous international residencies including at the Vermont Studio Center, and the School of Visual Arts in New York, as well as at the Harmattan Workshop led by Prof. Bruce Onobrakpeya. He has participated in international fairs and exhibitions including at the Johannesburg Artfair, Art 14, the Center for Contemporary Art Lagos, the Nigerian National Museum, E-week in Freiburg, Germany, as well as the Skoto Gallery in New York; his works are regularly featured at international auction houses including Philips de Pury, Bonhams, and Arthouse Contemporary. Kainebi Osahenye lives and works in Lagos, Nigeria.







REDEMPTION
Flattened aluminum cans, photo cut out of eyes, paint on panels (4 parts)
Dimension variable.
2012

₦16,500,000.00

Uchay
Joel Chima



Uchay Joel Chima (born 1971) graduated from the Art School of the Institute of Management and Technology, Enugu, Nigeria. Uchay is known for his eclectic use of alluring materials and unique artistic process, often questioning environmental and social issues around the world. He has created many avant garde works through media such as; performance art videos and two dimensional sculptures made from found objects. His works have continued to evolve, remaining relevant to developments in contemporary art.

A staunch environmentalist, Chima employs a wide range of found materials (including charcoal, old sacks, sand, strings, wax) to create thought provoking, mixed media works that force the viewer to recognize the importance of the discourse around climate change.

Uchay Joel Chima has participated in exhibitions in Nigeria, South Africa, Canada, Sweden, Germany, Netherlands, United Kingdom, and U.S.A. In 2009, he received the award for best video art project from the Center for Contemporary Art, in Lagos. He is one of the four artists chosen through a competitive international selection process to take part in 2015/2016 Platte forum's Artist Residency program in Denver, Colorado. He has been in residence at Vermont Studio Centre, Johnson, Vermont; Spark Box Studio in Ontario, Canada and also at the One Minute Foundation in Amsterdam, Netherlands. His works are featured at international auction houses including Bonhams, Art house Contemporary and Lagos Art Auction. Uchay maintains a studio in Lagos, Nigeria and Houston TX, USA.



CAUGHT UP (RAPTURED)
Mixed Media
62 x 43 inches
2019

₦1,800,000.00



DANCE II
Mixed Media
38 x 50 inches
2019

₦1,600,000.00



RED APPAREL
Mixed Media
36 x 50 inches
2019

₦1,800,000.00



RED AS CRIMSON
Mixed Media
40 x 50 inches
2019

₦1,800,000.00

Anthea Epelle



Self-taught artist Anthea Epelle (b.1972) creates paintings employing mainly oil on canvas. Born in London, England, Anthea schooled in Lagos and Port Harcourt and later studied Fashion, Design and Technology at The London College of Fashion, UK. She is inspired by expressions, texture, patterns, and alignment; all of which are reflective in her abstract and figurative work.

Since taking up painting professionally in 2007, Anthea has defined her creating process and is still evolving with her practice. She explores portraiture to a great degree and close-ups of these expansive faces call for attention. Anthea's art starts with exploration as she outlines her characters. She enjoys recreating the human face and though she is often drawn to painting women, The Fedora Man 2018 is as glorious. Her use of lines is delicate yet bold – they add a vibrancy that is subtly dramatic.

Group exhibitions include Nigeria Our Nigeria at the Presidential Inauguration Exhibition, Abuja (2011), The Contemporaries, at the Wheatbaker Lagos (2015), Women's Month at Rele Gallery, Lagos (2016) and the Afro Modernism in Abuja (2016). Several of her works have been sold at auction by Arthouse Contemporary.

Anthea is featured in the "Art of Nigerian Women" book by Chukwuemeka, launched in 2016.

Anthea's forward is "going back". She wants her art to take her back to her culture, history and roots; in which she plans to translate these on canvas, photography and fashion in a bid to liberate not only the viewer but herself.



CURIOSITY 1
Oil on recycled cartons_ paper on canvas
22 x 24 Inches
2021

~~₦~~300,000.00



CURIOSITY 2
Oil on recycled cartons_ paper on canvas
22 x 24 Inches
2021

~~₦~~300,000.00



HEAD IN THE CLOUDS 1
Oil on recycled wrapping paper on canvas
20 x 24 Inches
2021

₦300,000.00



HEAD IN THE CLOUDS 2
Oil on recycled cartons_ paper on canvas
20 x 24 Inches
2021

₦300,000.00



NOT PRESENT
Oil on recycled cartons_ paper on canvas
20 x 24 Inches
2021

₦300,000.00



SONG OF THE HEART
Oil on recycled cartons_ paper on canvas
20 x 24 Inches
2021

~~₦~~300,000.00

Tejuosho Olanrewaju

Olanrewaju Tejuoso is a painter, performance and installation artist, practicing in Nigeria. Born in Abeokuta, Ogun state of Nigeria, Tejuoso studied Fine Art at the University of Nigeria, Nsukka and graduated in 2001.

He is passionate about the environment and society. The central philosophy in his works is drawn "From Waste to Life". He believes that the concern for people and environment is divine. Working in found objects and trash, he engages in community projects that recycle waste into works of art. He uses trashed materials to call attention to the imbalance being exerted by man's domestic and industrial activities on the earth's ecosystem.

Olanrewaju has participated in various exhibition in Nigeria as well as internationally, in Senegal, Italy, and U. S. A. He has had artist residencies in Philadelphia, USA and Yogyakata, Indonesia. In 2018, he won the Prix Revelation in Dakar, Senegal.

Tejuoso is self- employed, and manages his own studio in Abeokuta.





MIRROR IN THE SUN
Soft plastic, copper wire, pins, aluminium, and rope
Installation varies
2021

$25,000.00



OMI INU AJERE
Soft plastic, copper wire, and pins
Installation varies
2020

$30,000.00



ORUN OHUN AYE
Soft plastic, copper wire, pins and rope
Installation varies
2021

$40,000.00



ORUN OHUN AYE II
Soft plastic, copper wire, pins and rope
Installation varies
2021

$40,000.00

Steve Ekpenisi

Born in 1978 in Abavo, Delta State, Steve Ekpenisi is a well known Nigerian sculptor. He began exploring art at the age of 5. He obtained a National Diploma (ND) in Painting and General Arts, as well as a Higher National Diploma in Sculpture from Auchi Polytechnic in 2003 and 2008 respectively.

His preferred medium is metal and his works are influenced by socio-economic and political realities, rich traditions and diverse beauty. He meticulously works with discarded metal plates, rods, stainless steel, scrap metal, and disposed cans of different products.

Steve has participated in several group exhibitions and created over 7 outdoor sculpture monuments in Nigeria. He is a member of Society of Nigerian Artists SNA, Universal Studios of Art, National Theatre, Iganmu, Lagos. He is also a member of Sculptors Association of Nigeria (SCAN).





KI UWAI
Mild steel strips
69 x 32 Inches
2020

₦4,500,000.00



OKEN ANU KÉWÉ EGON AZA ÉLAN SERIES
Mild steel strips
64 x 52 Inches
2021

~~₦~~5,500,000.00

Curator

Favour Ritaro is a Nigerian curator whose research and curatorial work is focused on personal and cultural identities. She explores how African artists capture, process, and map their cultural inheritance. Favour is interested in advancing ideas that challenge and enhance our understanding of the past within a curatorial purview that takes a critical view of representations of identity and nationhood, gender, and sexuality.

She is a recipient of the Association of Art Museum Curators Curatorial Mentorship Programme, New York, and ARAK Collection Curatorial Residency Fellowship. She received her B.A. in Art History from the Department of Fine and Applied Arts, Obafemi Awolowo University, Nigeria, and is currently pursuing a Masters in Curatorial Practice at the University of Bergen, Norway.

Some of her recent exhibitions include Home is Here and There, A Tale of Shared Experiences, at Artpedia Gallery, in Nigeria; and Arewa, Me Too, Apexart International Open Call.




Sustainability
Table SERIES